



Losing touchscreens

Some new BMWs won't have touchscreens due to the global chip shortage. <https://digit.in/nov21-48>



More tech regulations in China

"Operation Cyber Sword" by the Chinese government brings sweeping changes to e-commerce. <https://digit.in/nov21-49>

Boult Audio Airbass Soulpods

ANC TWS that struggles to stand out

Boult Audio is a home-grown audio company that has a vast portfolio of affordable audio products including wireless headphones, speakers, and TWS earbuds. The latest TWS offering from the company is the Boult Audio Airbass Soulpods, an Active Noise Cancelling pair of truly wireless earbuds priced at ₹2,999. How do these earphones perform and should you consider them over other competitors in this price range? Let's find out.

BUILD AND COMFORT

Sporting a rectangular-shaped charging case with a matte texture, the Boult Audio Airbass Soulpods have a mediocre build and design. The matte texture is resistant to fingerprints but can get smudged and scratched. There's an LED indicator on the front, a USB-C charging port on the left and a pairing button inside the case. The case's hinge feels very rickety and we're worried if it will stand the test of time.

As for the earbuds, they also sport a larger footprint than what we usually see these days. The buds have very long stems with the Boult Audio logo on the back. The top part of the stems is a touch-sensitive surface for gesture input for music and call controls.

The earbuds have an angled design for better fit and comfort. The buds fit moderately well but if you have smaller ears than usual, you may have difficulty finding the perfect fit with the provided ear tips.

FEATURES

The Boult Audio Airbass Soulpods comes packing features such as Active Noise Cancellation, Ambient Mode, IPX7 water resistance and USB Type-C connectivity. The earbuds do a mediocre job cancelling out ambient sounds on ANC mode but they don't match up to the performance of the Realme Buds Air 2.



There's no companion app support, so you cannot customise these earbuds at all. The earbuds have touch controls that can be used to pause or play music, skip tracks, activate voice assistant and change noise cancellation modes. There are no volume controls, which is disappointing.

There's also mono bud use where you can use either bud independently of each other. It comes with IPX7 rating which means they are resistant to sweat and splashes of water.

PERFORMANCE

The Boult Audio Airbass Soulpods feature 10mm drivers and support the SBC and AAC codecs. The Airbass Soulpods come with a bass-boosted, dark sound profile with boosted bass, decent mids, and underemphasised highs. The bass response has a lot of heft to it, so much so that it ends up sounding a bit muddy at times. The exaggerated bass response may appeal to bassheads especially when listening to genres such as rap, pop, hip hop, EDM, and Bollywood. However, we wish Boult Audio had tuned this part of the frequency range more conserva-

tively. However, these earbuds aren't as muddy sounding as the Redmi Earbuds 3 Pro that is priced the same.

As for microphone performance, the Boult Audio Airbass Soulpods really surprised us with its performance here. The microphone picks up sound well and produces natural-sounding voices during calls with minimal distortion.

BATTERY LIFE

The Boult Audio Airbass Soulpods' battery life is rated at 24 hours, earbuds and charging case combined. The buds themselves are rated at 6 hours of wireless playback time on a single charge.

If you turn the ANC feature on, the earbuds' battery life drops lower.

In our testing, we recorded 4.5 hours of playtime on the buds with ANC turned on. The case provided 3-4 additional charges.

VERDICT

Priced at ₹2,999, the Boult Audio Airbass Soulpods are a decent option for

those who want to immerse themselves in the world of ANC without breaking the bank. However, with many brands offering the same and more at under 3K, the Boult Audio Airbass Soulpods struggles to stand out in this segment. While the earbuds have a bass-boosted sound signature that would be liked by bass lovers and a great microphone, the sound signature is a bit too dark and muddy.

—Dhriti Datta



BUILD	62
FEATURES	62
PERFORMANCE	65
VALUE	68

SPECIFICATIONS

HEADPHONE TYPE: In-ear truly wireless | BLUETOOTH: v5.0 | BLUETOOTH RANGE: 10m (33 feet) | IP RATING: IPX7 | CHARGING: USB Type-C | FREQUENCY RESPONSE: 20 Hz - 20kHz | AUDIO CODECS: SBC, AAC | DRIVER SIZE: 10mm | BATTERY LIFE (EARBUDS): 6 hours (without ANC), 4.5 hours (with ANC) | BATTERY LIFE (TOTAL): 24 hours | COLOURS: White, Black

CONTACT

BOULT AUDIO | PHONE: (+91)9555-602-502 | EMAIL: support@boultaudio.com | WEBSITE: <https://www.boultaudio.com/>